earned savings in their respective DCCBs, they found it impossible also to open new accounts in public sector banks, besieged as they were by demonetization queues. In a single stroke their entire working capital and life's savings had been rendered worthless – a move that was appalling for its injustice, and unforgiveable for its callousness.

In addition, farmers now had no usable money to buy seeds or fertilizers or pay labour for planting the rabi crop. The DCCBs, who customarily played a significant role in providing credit to the farm sector, were faced with a liquidity crisis, as the RBI had also barred the DCCBs from depositing the junked notes with them, claiming the notes had no legitimate trail to prove their source. Since the RBI refused to exchange the demonetized currency they had already accepted from their account holders – a majority of whom were farmers – they moved the Supreme Court for redressal, claiming the notes collected by them were legitimate.[43]

In the meanwhile, farmers suffered. Deprived unfairly of their own money and unable to take loans from their bankers, they were forced into the arms of usurious moneylenders just to have enough money to survive and to plant the next crop. The anger and protests by farmers across the country, since demonetization, are both understandable and justified in view of the devastation they suffered because of the note ban.

Another RBI circular which caused a great deal of confusion and ridicule was the poorly considered notification instructing banks to mark a customer's fingers with indelible ink after he/she had exchanged money.[44] In an attempt to prevent customers from exchanging more than the stipulated limit of ₹2,000, the RBI instructed banks and post offices to 'put indelible ink mark on the right index finger of the customer so as to identify that he/she has exchanged the old currency notes only once'. It further stated that, 'Each bank branch will be provided with black indelible ink bottles of 5 ml each', and 'The indelible ink can be applied by the cashier or any other official designated by the bank before the notes are given to the